

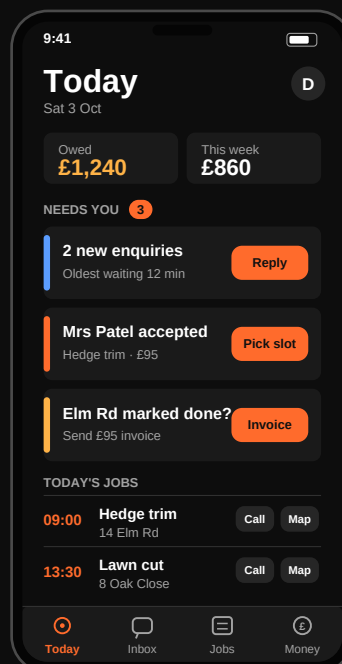
Trader Mobile Experience

Design spec v0.1 · October 2026

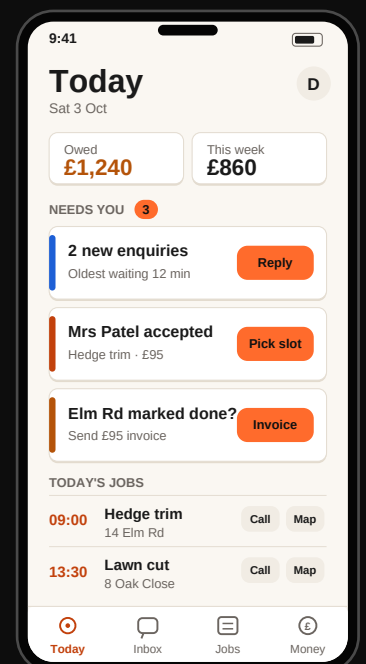
How the sole trader uses Trade Forge from the van, the lawn and the loft: four screens that matter, a light and dark theme that pop equally, and the rules that keep it fast on site.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- Principles and structure (four tabs)
- Today, Inbox, Job card, Quote flow, Money and MTD
- Light and dark theme system, with contrast checks
- Onboarding, offline and PWA constraints
- Notifications, scope and open questions



DARK



LIGHT

Draft for team review · Internal use only
All figures and names in wireframes are illustrative.

Principles

The mobile experience is not a CRM shrunk to fit a phone. The trader is on site all day, hands dirty, with 30 seconds free. Admin happens in the van, at lunch or in the evening. WhatsApp stays the front door; the app is the cockpit that answers one question: what needs me now?

TWO SURFACES, ONE PRODUCT

WhatsApp: customers and traders already live here. Enquiries, quotes, invoices and reminders all travel through it, and a trader can run the whole business without opening the app.

The app: a faster multi-job overview. It adds the Today list, one-tap stage changes, photos on jobs and the money picture. It is optional and must never feel like a second job.

Actions over information

Every screen leads with the next thing to do and a single button to do it. Charts and reports come last.

One thumb, dirty hands, bright sun

Primary actions sit in the bottom thumb zone. Large tap targets. Both themes tuned for daylight and for a dark van.

Plain trade language

"Money owed", "Send invoice", "Done". No accounting or CRM jargon anywhere in the app.

Voice and camera over typing

Dictated job notes, photo receipts, photos attached to jobs. Numeric keypads for prices, never a full keyboard.

Design tests every screen must pass

- Can a trader complete the main action one-handed in under 10 seconds, standing up?
- Does it still work with one bar of signal? (see Offline, section 8)
- Is it legible in direct sun and in a van at night, in both themes?
- Would a plumber with no training know what the biggest button does?

Four tabs, one pipeline

Navigation is four bottom tabs, reachable by thumb. Everything else (settings, expenses history, help) lives behind the avatar on Today. No hamburger menu.

Today	Inbox	Jobs	Money
Action cards: what needs me now Owed and this-week strip Today's jobs with Call and Map	WhatsApp threads with stage chips Swipe to advance stage Quote button in composer Reply-window warnings	Job card is the core unit Stage ladder and one big button Photos, notes (voice), address Quote and invoice from here	Owed, received, booked, done Overdue list with Remind MTD-ready export Snap a receipt

One pipeline, five colours

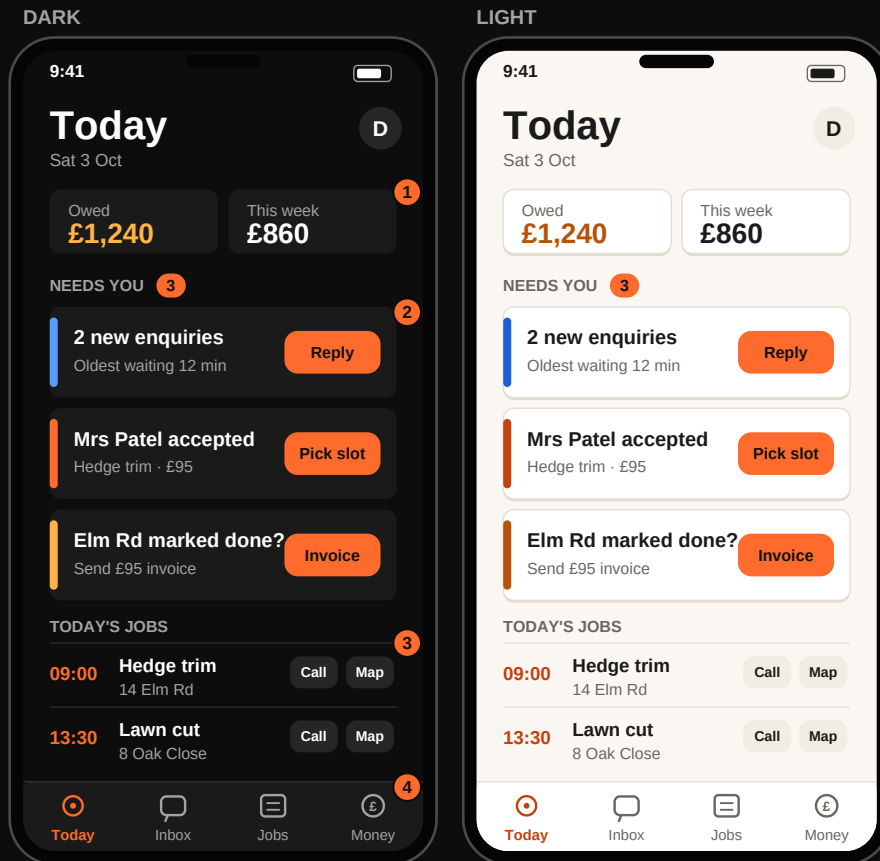
Seven stages collapse into five colour groups so the whole app reads at a glance. Colour is never the only signal: every chip carries its label.

Enquiry	Quoted	Booked	Scheduled	Completed	Due	Paid
Inbox	Inbox	Jobs	Jobs	Jobs	Jobs + Money	Money

TO CONFIRM: STAGE NAMES DIFFER BETWEEN DOCUMENTS

The micro-CRM spec v2.0 uses Lead / Quoted / Job Booked / Paid. The business overview uses Booked / Scheduled / Completed / Due for payment / Paid. This spec proposes one unified ladder: Enquiry and Quoted are inbox stages, and the job card ladder starts at Booked. Whichever names the team lands on, the UI needs them agreed before build.

The home screen



1 Two numbers only

Owed and this week. Money owed is first because it is the number that changes behaviour.

2 Action cards

One next action each, one button, a stage-colour accent. Cards disappear when done, so an empty list feels like winning.

3 Today's jobs

Time, job, address. Call and Map are one tap, so there is no digging through threads while driving.

4 Thumb-reach tabs

Four tabs, labelled, with the active tab in orange.

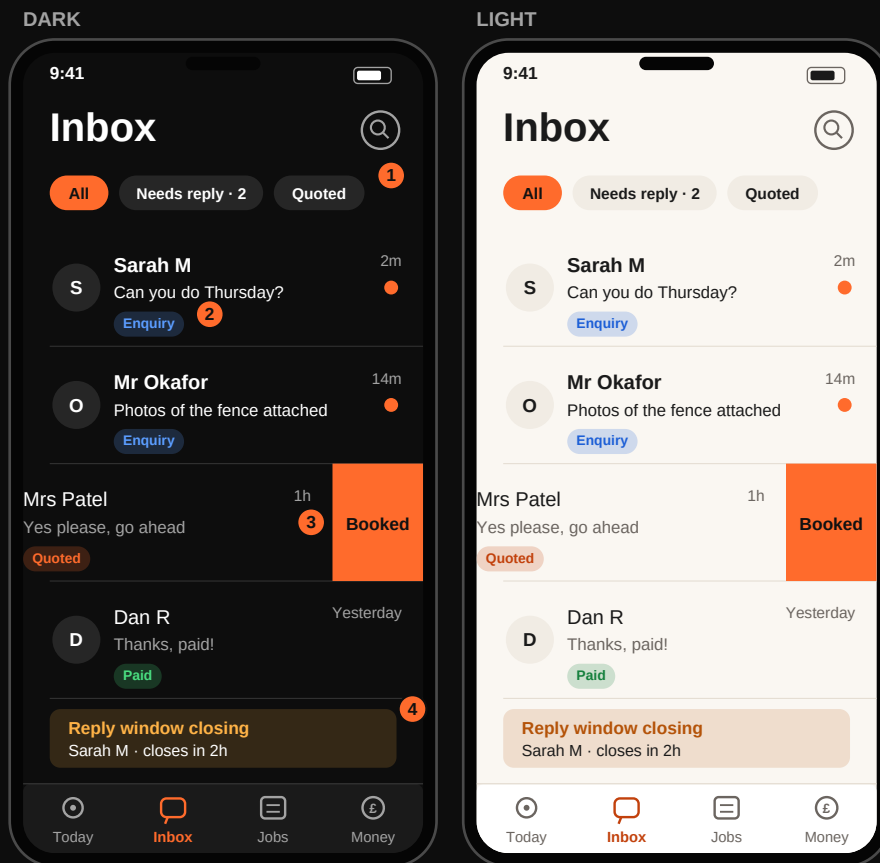
Card ranking (proposal)

- 1. Customer waiting for a reply, oldest first
- 2. Accepted quote needing a slot
- 3. Finished job with no invoice sent
- 4. Overdue payment
- 5. MTD deadline inside 14 days

Behaviour

- Tapping a card button opens the action pre-filled (Reply opens the thread, Invoice opens a ready PDF).
- Swipe a card to snooze until tomorrow. Nothing is lost; it returns on Today.
- Pull to refresh. Live updates arrive by push when the app is closed.
- Empty state: "All clear. Nothing needs you." plus today's jobs.

WhatsApp threads, with stages



- 1 **Filters**
All, Needs reply, Quoted. Needs reply is the default landing filter from Today.
- 2 **Stage chip on every thread**
The pipeline is visible without leaving the inbox. Chips are colour plus label.
- 3 **Swipe to advance**
Swipe a row to move it to its next stage. A single orange target names the stage it will move to.
- 4 **Reply-window banner**
Free-form replies are only allowed within 24 hours of the customer's last message. The banner warns before it closes.

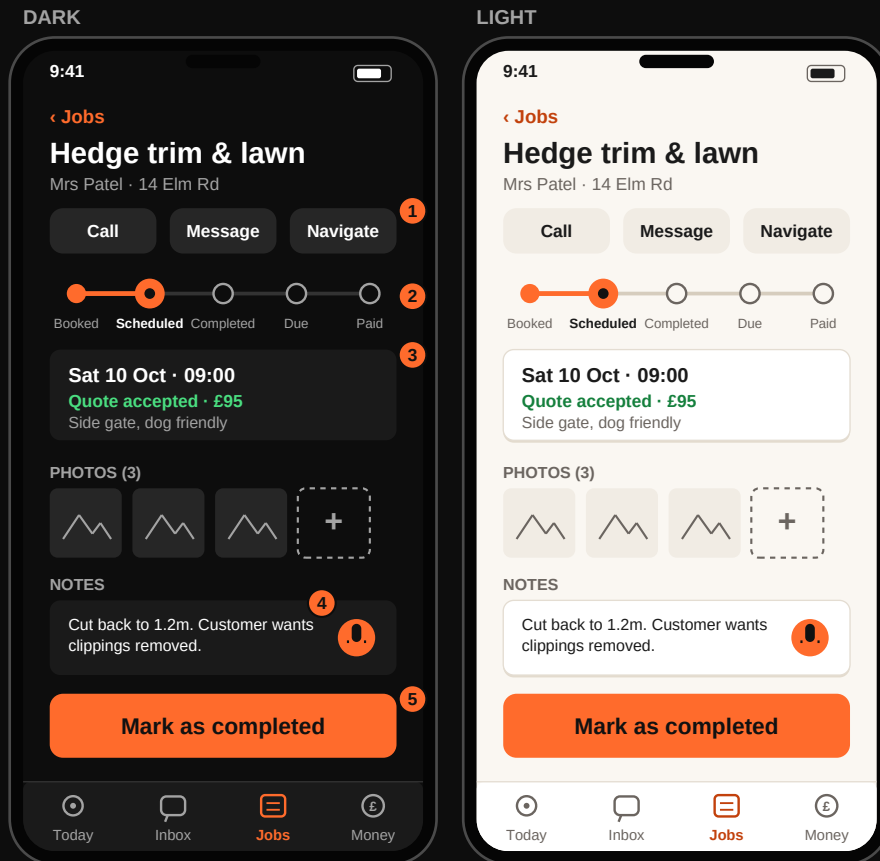
Thread view

- Mirrors WhatsApp: bubbles, ticks, photos inline.
- Composer has a Send quote button beside the attach icon.
- Customer photos attach to the job in one tap.

When the window has closed

- Composer is replaced by a clear message: "Replying now needs an approved template."
- Offer the relevant template (follow-up, reminder) with a preview.
- Warn before messaging anyone who has not messaged first (opt-in rules).

The core unit



- 1 **Call, Message, Navigate**
The three things a trader does before arriving at a job, one tap each.
- 2 **Stage ladder**
Booked to Paid. Tap a stage to jump; the big button moves one step.
- 3 **Details card**
Date, quote status, access notes. Everything needed on the doorstep.
- 4 **Voice notes**
Mic button transcribes. No typing with dirty hands.
- 5 **One big button**
The label always names the next step: Mark as completed, Send invoice, Mark as paid.

Rules

- Marking Completed immediately offers Send invoice, prefilled from the accepted quote.
- Photos open full screen and can be sent to the customer in chat.
- Every stage change is one tap with undo for 5 seconds.

Offline

- Today's jobs and their details are cached.
- Stage changes and notes save locally with a visible "Saved, will sync" state, then reconcile when signal returns.

Three taps to send

Template, price, send. The same flow produces an invoice from the accepted quote. The app remembers the last price used for each service, so a repeat quote is one tap. Themes alternate below for illustration; every screen exists in both.

1 Choose the job

2 Set the price

3 Review and send

Why it works

- Large numeric keypad. No keyboard needed.
- Price suggestion from the last quote for the same service.
- PDF preview is always white paper, in both themes, so it looks like what the customer receives.

Behaviour

- Customer taps Accept in chat; the job moves to Booked automatically.
- Invoice uses the same screens, prefilled from the job.
- Quote templates are seeded per trade at onboarding.

Cash and tax, without accounting jargon

DARK

The dark theme mockup shows a 'Money' app interface. At the top, there's a status bar with time 9:41 and battery. Below is a header 'Money' with tabs for 'Week', 'Month', and 'Quarter'. The main content area has four boxes: 'Booked £2,100', 'Done £1,480', 'Owed £1,240', and 'Received £860'. Below this is an 'OVERDUE' section with two entries: 'Mr Okafor 9 days overdue £340' and 'Ms Hughes 4 days overdue £185', each with a 'Remind' button. Further down is an 'MTD-ready export' section with a note 'Quarter 2 update due 7 Nov · 35 days' and an 'Export records' button. At the bottom is a large orange button '+ Snap a receipt'. The bottom navigation bar has icons for 'Today', 'Inbox', 'Jobs', and 'Money' (highlighted).

LIGHT

The light theme mockup shows the same 'Money' app interface. The layout is identical to the dark theme, but with a light background. The 'Booked' amount is £2,100, 'Done' is £1,480, 'Owed' is £1,240, and 'Received' is £860. The 'OVERDUE' section lists 'Mr Okafor 9 days overdue £340' and 'Ms Hughes 4 days overdue £185' with 'Remind' buttons. The 'MTD-ready export' section includes the same note and 'Export records' button. The bottom navigation bar is also present with 'Today', 'Inbox', 'Jobs', and 'Money' (highlighted).

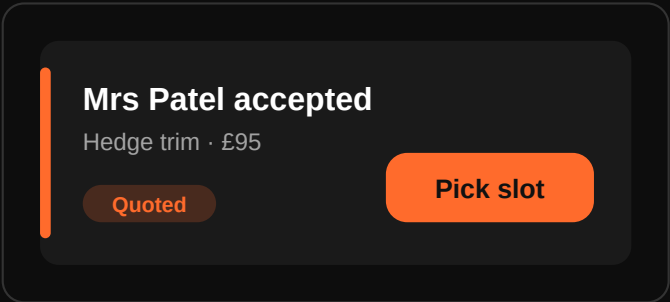
- 1 **Week, Month, Quarter**
Four numbers for the period: booked, done, owed, received.
- 2 **Overdue with Remind**
One tap sends a friendly WhatsApp payment reminder. Preview before sending.
- 3 **MTD-ready export**
Next deadline and one button to export the quarter's records for HMRC-recognised software or an accountant.
- 4 **Snap a receipt**
Camera opens straight away. Category and job are suggested; the trader just confirms.

WORDING MATTERS

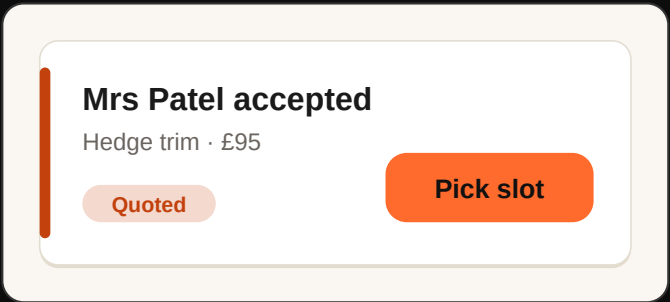
Always say "MTD-ready export" or "records for MTD". Trade Forge is the record-keeping layer, not filing software, and nothing on screen should imply it submits to HMRC. Confirm the export counts as an acceptable digital link under HMRC guidance before launch (see business overview).

Light and dark, equally punchy

Light mode is a first-class theme, not an inversion. Both themes share the same brand fill, the same type scale and the same layout. Only surfaces, text and the colour of "orange as text" change.



DARK



LIGHT

Colour tokens

Token	Dark	Light	Notes
Background	 #0D0D0D	 #FAF7F2	Light uses warm paper, not stark white
Surface (cards)	 #1A1A1A	 #FFFFFF	White cards lift off the paper background
Surface raised	 #262626	 #F1ECE4	Inputs, secondary buttons
Text	 #FFFFFF	 #1A1A1A	Near-black, not pure black
Text muted	 #A3A3A3	 #6B6560	Secondary labels
Border	 #333333	 #E4DDD2	Plus soft shadow in light
Primary fill	 #FF6B2C	 #FF6B2C	Identical in both themes, with #111111 label
Orange as text/icon	 #FF6B2C	 #C2410C	Deep orange on light for contrast
Amber (warning)	 #FFB347	 #B45309	Amber fill with dark label also works on both
Success (Paid)	 #4ADE80	 #15803D	Always paired with a label

Rules that make light mode pop

Same brand fill, both themes

Primary buttons are Forge Orange with a near-black label in light and dark. It is the one element that must look identical, so the brand reads instantly either way.

Never orange text on white

Pure Forge Orange fails contrast as text on light. Use Forge Orange Deep (#C2410C) for text, links and icons in light mode.

Warm paper, white cards

A warm off-white background with white cards, a 1px warm border and a soft shadow gives the same sense of lift that lighter surfaces give in dark.

Elevation differs by theme

Dark: lighter surface steps. Light: border plus shadow. Never both flat.

Stage colours get a light variant

Each of the five stage colours has a darker light-mode shade. Chips are always colour plus label.

Documents are always white paper

Quote and invoice previews look the same in both themes because the customer sees one version.

Contrast checks (WCAG: 4.5 for body text, 3 for large text and UI)

Pair	Dark	Light
Text on background	19.4 : 1 pass	16.3 : 1 pass
Muted text on surface	6.9 : 1 pass	5.7 : 1 pass
Orange as text on surface	6.1 : 1 pass	5.2 : 1 pass
Amber as text on surface	9.8 : 1 pass	5.0 : 1 pass
Button label on Forge Orange	6.6 : 1 pass	6.6 : 1 pass

Process

- Default to System (follow the phone), with a manual Light / Dark / System switch in settings.
- Hypothesis to test: light reads better in direct sun and dark is kinder in the van at night. Check both outdoors before locking defaults.
- Every screen in review is shown in both themes. A screen is not done until it is checked in both.

Getting in, and staying fast

1 Sign in

One tap with Google, Apple or Microsoft. No password.

2 Pick your trade

Seeds services, quote templates and starting prices.

3 Connect WhatsApp

Embedded Signup. Server exchanges the auth code immediately (30 second life).

4 First sync

Coexistence keeps the existing app working. Show clear sync status and what to expect.

5 Add to Home Screen

Coached step so push notifications work on iPhone. Skippable, with a reminder card on Today.

6 Land on Today

First real conversation visible. Goal: under 5 minutes end to end.

Where it can go wrong, and what the UI does

Risk	Design response
Popup or app-switch loses the 30 second auth code	Exchange immediately on return, show a clear retry button, and resume where the trader left off.
Trader already has a WABA made through a developer app	Friendly explainer and a support path. It cannot be onboarded through Embedded Signup.
Push on iPhone needs the PWA on the Home Screen	Coach the install in onboarding and keep a reminder card on Today until done.
Poor signal in vans and basements	Cache today's jobs. Queue stage changes and notes locally with a visible Saved state.
Sockets do not run when the PWA is in the background	Use web push to wake the app. Use the live socket only while the app is open.

Platform

- PWA at launch (web signup, no Apple in-app purchase). Expo / React Native later, as already decided.
- The four-tab structure and both themes carry across unchanged.
- Check App Store rules on signup and payment before the native build.

Notifications, scope, open questions

Push is the main retention lever, so it is spent carefully. Every push has exactly one action and deep-links straight to it. All timings below are proposals to validate.

Trigger	Example	Opens	Timing
New enquiry	Sarah M: Can you do Thursday?	Thread, composer ready	Immediate
Quote accepted	Mrs Patel accepted £95	Slot picker	Immediate
Job finished?	Elm Rd done? Send £95 invoice	Prefilled invoice	After scheduled end
Payment overdue	Mr Okafor is 9 days overdue	Reminder preview	Once daily at most
MTD deadline	Quarter 2 update due in 7 days	Export screen	14, 7 and 2 days before

- Quiet hours by default (for example 20:00 to 07:30), configurable.
- Non-urgent items roll into Today instead of pushing, after about five pushes in a day.
- For traders who never open the app, the same nudges can arrive over WhatsApp from the platform number.

Out of scope on mobile v1

- Calendar grid views
- Charts and reports
- Multi-user accounts
- Broadcast marketing messages
- Deep settings pages

Open questions

- Stage names: unify the two documents (section 2).
- Scheduling depth: v2.0 spec puts it out of scope, the overview includes slot picking.
- Customer reminder wording, consent and template approval.
- Cost of utility templates sent outside the 24 hour window, and for any WhatsApp mirror notifications.
- Theme default: System or light-first?

NEXT STEPS

- 1 Team review of this spec (stage names and theme default first).
- 2 Clickable prototype of Today and Job card in both themes.
- 3 Field test with 3 gardeners, in the van and outdoors.
- 4 Lock tokens, then spec v0.2: invoices, expenses and settings.